

Three decades of building, breaking and **scaling technology** — on your terms.

A prospectus for CEOs and boards weighing how to lead technology without betting the company on a single permanent hire. This is what 27 years of owning and running technology, telecom and finance businesses buys you — applied to your roadmap, your margins and your risk.

27

Years owning & operating technology businesses

5+

Industries built in: hardware, software, ISP, finance, agency

P&L

Founder-level ownership, not just a job title

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Months of ramp-up before value lands

WHY A CEO SHOULD READ THIS

You don't have a technology problem. You have a **decision-making** problem with technology at the centre of it — which platform to bet on, what to build versus buy, where the next dollar of margin hides, and whether the team you have can take you where the board wants to go.

Most companies answer that by hiring an expensive full-time CTO, or by leaving the call to whoever shouts loudest in the engineering room. There is a third option that more boards are choosing: bring in someone who has already owned the whole problem — the building, the billing, the

infrastructure, the financing and the exit — and rent the judgement, not the headcount.

“I've signed the front of the cheques and the back of them. I've built the product, run the network it rode on, and financed the customers who bought it. There aren't many technology decisions I'm seeing for the first time.”

A OPERATOR'S TRACK RECORD — NOT A RÉSUMÉ OF JOB TITLES

For 27 years I have owned the companies, carried the risk and lived with the outcomes. The breadth matters because modern technology decisions cut across all of it at once.

HARDWARE

Built and ran hardware businesses

Sourcing, supply chains, margins on physical goods, support and RMA, and the brutal cash-flow discipline that selling tangible product demands. I know what it costs to ship something real.

SOFTWARE

Owned software companies end to end

Product strategy, build vs. buy, release cycles, technical debt and the day-to-day reality of shipping software people pay for — from spec to support desk.

TELECOMMUNICATIONS

Operated Internet Service Providers

Networks, uptime, scale, peering and infrastructure under real load. When you've run an ISP, "the cloud" holds no mystery — it's just someone else's data centre with a markup.

○ FINANCE

Founded and ran finance companies

Lending, risk, compliance, regulation and the unit economics of money itself. I read a balance sheet the way most CTOs read a stack trace — and I connect technology decisions to it.

○ TODAY · DIGITAL ONE AGENCY

Turning all of it into outcomes for clients

Today that combined experience runs through Digital One Agency — applying operator-grade technology leadership to growth businesses that need the judgement without the overhead.

WHAT A FRACTIONAL CTO ENGAGEMENT ACTUALLY DELIVERS

STRATEGY

Technology roadmap tied to the P&L

A clear 12–24 month plan where every technology bet maps to revenue, cost or risk — written in language the board understands, not jargon.

ARCHITECTURE

Build vs. buy, decided correctly

Hard-won judgement on what to build, what to buy, and what to kill — so you stop paying for the wrong things and over-engineering the rest.

TEAM

Hiring, leading & levelling up engineers

Recruit the right people, fix the structure, mentor the leads, and know when you genuinely need a full-timer versus a contractor.

VENDORS

Vendor & cost control

From an operator who has been the vendor — I negotiate contracts, audit cloud and SaaS spend, and cut the fat without breaking the system.

RISK

Security, uptime & compliance

Infrastructure that stays up, data that stays safe, and the governance the board needs to sleep — grounded in years of running networks and regulated finance.

DILIGENCE

Investment & M&A readiness

Technical due diligence, scalability assessments and the credibility that reassures investors and acquirers your technology is an asset, not a liability.

WHY FRACTIONAL WORKS — THE BOARD-LEVEL CASE

A full-time CTO at the seniority you actually want costs a base salary, equity, bonus, super and the long tail of recruitment and ramp-up — often well north of a quarter-million a year before they've delivered a thing. And for most companies, the role is only genuinely full-time during bursts: a re-platform, a funding round, a turnaround.

Full-time CTO hire

High fixed cost · long commitment

- \$250k+ all-in, every year, regardless of workload
- 3-6 months to recruit, more to ramp
- One person's experience, often from one industry
- Hard and expensive to unwind if it's the wrong fit
- Frequently under-utilised once the big project lands

Fractional CTO — Digital One Agency

Flexible cost · senior judgement on tap

- Pay only for the leadership you actually need
- Productive in week one — no ramp, no learning curve
- 27 years across five industries, in one operator
- Scale up for a project, scale down when it's done
- Founder-grade accountability without the headcount

Fractional isn't "CTO-lite." It's senior leadership matched to the moments that need it — and an honest advisor whose incentive is your outcome, not protecting a permanent seat.

HOW WE'D WORK TOGETHER

- **1. Diagnostic.** A short, fixed engagement to assess your stack, team, spend and risk — you get a written findings report whether or not we continue.
- **2. Roadmap.** A prioritised plan tied to commercial outcomes, with clear owners and timelines the board can hold to.
- **3. Execution.** Ongoing fractional leadership — a set number of days per month, embedded with your team, driving the roadmap.
- **4. Hand-off.** When the heavy lifting is done, I help you hire the permanent team or step back to a light-touch advisory cadence. No lock-in.

WHY CHOOSE US

- **Owner's mindset.** I've carried payroll and signed the leases. I treat your money like mine because for 27 years it was.
- **Unusual breadth.** Hardware, software, networks and finance under one operator — so cross-cutting decisions get made by someone who's lived every side.
- **Plain English.** I translate between the engineering room and the boardroom without losing either side.
- **No empire-building.** I'll tell you when you don't need to spend, hire or build. Few full-time CTOs are incentivised to.
- **Skin in the outcome.** Engagements are structured around your results, not my hours.

Let's pressure-test your technology strategy

Start with a no-obligation diagnostic conversation. Bring your hardest technology question — the one that's been sitting on the board agenda — and let's see what 27 years of operating makes of it.

Book a diagnostic call

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